Brotherhood

Current company version · generated from the structured master script

CHOSEN: THE STORY BEFORE THE MANGER

SCENE 5 — BROTHERHOOD

TRANSITION FROM SCENE 4

Scene 4 ends somewhere else in Nazareth with the dangerous echo: 'That's what I heard.'

One beat.

BANG!

A hammer strikes wood.

BANG!

A second strike.

BANG-BANG!

Lights cut to Joseph's work area. The tonal shift should be immediate: warmth, laughter, physical energy.

JOSEPH, LEVI, MALACHI, CALEB, and EZRA are already working together. The unfinished table from Scene 2 is now unmistakably the project.

The satchel Mary made Joseph is on him. Do not feature it yet.

A hand slaps a workbench.

Suddenly—

JOSEPH'S WORLD.

Bright.

Alive.

Rhythmic.

JOSEPH, LEVI, MALACHI, CALEB and EZRA are already working.

They do not stand in a line.

The worksite is constantly moving

wood passes from hand to hand;

tools change owners;

measurements are called;

benches move;

pieces are lifted;

someone climbs;

someone ducks;

someone catches something at the last second.

Everything feels practiced.

These men have worked together for years.

WORK BEFORE WORDS

Do not begin with dialogue. Let the audience watch the men work.

Joseph checks a length. Levi takes weight. Ezra checks alignment. Malachi steadies a piece. Caleb tries to help and is just useful enough to remain employed.

The physical vocabulary beneath the sequence is MEASURE -> MARK -> CUT -> SET. It may be expressed through movement rather than repeated as lyrics.

Hammer strikes, scraping wood, footwork, hand-claps, and safe prop percussion begin to align into a musical pulse.

JOSEPH
Hold that.

CALEB
I am holding it.

EZRA
You're leaning on it.

CALEB
That is a form of holding.

LEVI
Move.

Levi takes the weight cleanly.

CALEB
See? Teamwork.

MALACHI
That is not what happened.

CALEB
It's what I experienced.

They keep working. The rhythm continues underneath.

JOSEPH IN HIS ELEMENT

Joseph stops and looks at a piece Caleb has handled.

JOSEPH
Caleb.

CALEB
What?

Joseph points at it.

JOSEPH
Look at it.

Caleb looks.

CALEB
I am.

JOSEPH
And?

Caleb studies it harder.

CALEB
Strong.

JOSEPH
Caleb.

CALEB
Very strong.

Ezra steps over, looks once.

EZRA
One side is higher.

CALEB
Only if you compare it to the other side.

Beat.

LEVI
That's usually how sides work.

Joseph takes the piece from Caleb.

CALEB
You don't trust my work.

JOSEPH
I trust you completely.

Caleb softens, pleased.

CALEB
Thank you.

JOSEPH
Your work is another matter.

The men laugh. Joseph resets the piece, and the music/movement picks back up.

MARRIAGE BANTER

Levi notices Joseph working on another piece.

LEVI
Hold on.

Whose is that?

JOSEPH
Customer's.

EZRA
No.

JOSEPH
No?

EZRA
Different wood.

Different finish.

Ezra watches Joseph inspect the table.

EZRA
And you've checked that corner four times.

CALEB
Four?

He GASPS.

CALEB
Oh, we've lost him.

JOSEPH
I'm standing right here.

LEVI
That's for Mary.

Joseph continues working.

LEVI
Too late. They know.

CALEB
It's for the house!

JOSEPH
Caleb—

CALEB
He's building the house!

LEVI
Man hasn't even married her, and he's already building furniture.

MALACHI
At least he'll have somewhere to sleep after she gets tired of him.

Joseph looks at Malachi.

JOSEPH
You too?

MALACHI
Wisdom comes in many forms.

EZRA
This one appears to be a table.

Joseph stops. Looks at Ezra.

EZRA
What?

It's obviously a table.

CALEB
How big is this thing?

JOSEPH
Big enough.

EZRA
That is not a measurement.

LEVI
Who's sitting at it?

JOSEPH
People.

CALEB
How many people?

JOSEPH
Six.

Ezra looks at the table.

EZRA
That's not a six-person table.

JOSEPH
It might be eight.

Beat.

Caleb slowly turns toward Joseph.

CALEB
Eight?

Joseph keeps working.

CALEB
Joseph.

JOSEPH
What?

CALEB
Eight?

JOSEPH
People visit.

LEVI
Of course.

EZRA
Very small people, apparently.

Caleb realizes.

CALEB
Children.

JOSEPH
I didn't say that.

CALEB
You built it.

The others laugh.

CALEB
How many?

JOSEPH
Caleb.

CALEB
You've counted.

JOSEPH
I have not.

EZRA
He has.

JOSEPH
Ezra.

EZRA
Evidence suggests—

JOSEPH
Nobody asked for evidence.

LEVI
Eight means there's room.

Joseph's defensiveness softens.

JOSEPH
That's the idea.

MALACHI
Room for what?

Joseph looks at the table.

This time he answers without joking.

JOSEPH
Family.

Friends.

Beat.

JOSEPH
Whoever needs a place.

That quiets them for just a moment.

Then—

CALEB
And children.

JOSEPH
Go cut something.

CALEB
Gladly.

Caleb grabs the appropriate piece and launches back into the work.

JOSEPH
Not that one.

Caleb freezes.

CALEB
I knew that.

EZRA
Evidence suggests—

CALEB
Nobody asked for evidence.

The men laugh.

The men laugh and return to the work rhythm. Joseph tries to hide how pleased he is, which only confirms everything.

SATCHEL CONTINUITY

Caleb reaches for a tool and notices Joseph's satchel.

CALEB
You still carrying that?

JOSEPH
It's a tool satchel.

CALEB
Then where are the tools?

Joseph instinctively checks.

The others notice the satchel is nearly empty.

EZRA
Interesting.

JOSEPH
Don't.

CALEB
She made you a satchel, and now you're protecting it from the tools.

JOSEPH
I use it.

LEVI
For what?

Joseph looks at all of them.

JOSEPH
For carrying things.

CALEB
Like feelings?

Joseph throws a rag at Caleb. Caleb catches it triumphantly.

CALEB
See? Now it's useful.

Back into the work.

“BROTHERHOOD” BEGINS

The carpentry pulse now expands into the full Brotherhood sequence.

This should feel rehearsed and exciting, but never disconnected from the work. The men are not presenting choreography to the audience; they are working so instinctively together that the work becomes choreography.

Movement possibilities: passing wood in counter-rhythm; coordinated lifts; safe tool-handling phrases; turns generated by carrying material; foot-stomps; hand-claps; bench/wood percussion; a repeated lift-set-release pattern; Caleb adding unnecessary flourishes that the others repeatedly correct.

Joseph should eventually stop supervising every beat and fully join the physical joy. We need to see him young, competitive, laughing and completely at home with these men.

PERCUSSIVE PATTERN

HAMMER — HAMMER — SAW — CLAP — FOOT

HAMMER — HAMMER — SAW — CLAP — FOOT

The men begin passing tools in rhythm.

Movement becomes sharper.

Angular.

Masculine.

Precise.

The dialogue starts locking into tempo.

ALL
MEASURE.

ALL
MARK.

ALL
CUT.

JOSEPH
AGAIN.

ALL
LIFT.

ALL
SET!

BANG!

JOSEPH
Too high!

JOSEPH
Too low.

JOSEPH
Move!

JOSEPH
Slow.

JOSEPH
Together.

ALL

HIT!

The piece lands perfectly.

RHYTHMIC SPOKEN SECTION

JOSEPH
If it's heavy—

ALL
We lift it!

JOSEPH
If it's crooked—

ALL
We fix it!

JOSEPH
If it's broken—

ALL
We mend it!

CALEB
If it's food!!!!

ALL
CALEB!!!

CALEB
I was going to say share it.

EZRA
No, you weren't.

The audience laughs.

The work continues.

JOSEPH
Side by side—

JOSEPH
Hand to hand—

JOSEPH
Know the measure—

JOSEPH
Know the plan—

JOSEPH
And if the plan goes bad—

Everyone stops.

Looks at Caleb.

CALEB
We blame Ezra!

EZRA
Why me?

CALEB
You look responsible.

The rhythm immediately resumes.

“BROTHERHOOD” — CALL AND RESPONSE

This portion may become sung/spoken/rap-adjacent depending on Christian's composition.

The text can ultimately be shaped musically, but the dramatic territory is

JOSEPH
You don't build alone.

MEN
No.

JOSEPH
You don't stand alone.

MEN
No.

JOSEPH
When one man loses his footing—

MEN
We hold him.

JOSEPH
When one man misses the measure—

MEN
We show him!

Dance Break

ALL

THE BROTHERHOOD
Work together.

Stand together.

Build together.

BANG!

ALL
Brothers don't let brothers fall.

CHOREOGRAPHIC FEATURE

The music expands into approximately 20–30 seconds of instrumental choreography.

This is the major visual payoff of the scene.

MOVEMENT LANGUAGE

Use

sharp foot patterns;

synchronized stomps;

body percussion;

tool percussion;

bench work;

rhythmic passing of lumber;

jumps over low work pieces where safe;

sliding underneath beams;

controlled vaults by trained performers;

quick level changes;

canon movement;

tight unison sections;

athletic turns;

five-man formations that constantly break and reform.

The choreography should feel as though construction itself has become dance.

One man throws a lightweight piece of wood.

Another catches it on count.

Hammer.

Spin.

Pass.

Duck.

Stomp.

Clap.

BANG!

Joseph lands the last strike.

Silence.

APPLAUSE BUTTON OPPORTUNITY.

Laughter. Breath. The men remain in the world of the workshop rather than posing for applause.

CALEB
That is how you build a table.

EZRA
You contributed almost nothing.

CALEB
Morale.

LEVI
You were the reason morale was necessary.

Caleb considers that.

CALEB
Still counts.

Joseph looks at the table. He is pleased despite himself.

MALACHI
You're happy.

Joseph looks at him.

JOSEPH
Is that a question?

MALACHI
No.

Joseph looks toward the table again, then unconsciously touches or adjusts the satchel.

JOSEPH
Good.

CALEB
That's it?

JOSEPH
What?

CALEB
The man is getting married, building a table for half of Nazareth, and all we get is 'good.'

LEVI
Leave him alone.

CALEB
I am celebrating him.

EZRA
Aggressively.

JOSEPH
I am happy.

That lands. Joseph does not need a speech.

JOSEPH
Very.

The others see that he means it.

THE BROTHERHOOD PROMISE

CALEB
Then remember us when you become respectable.

JOSEPH
Too late for you.

CALEB
Exactly. Someone has to protect you from it.

LEVI
We're finishing this tomorrow.

EZRA
Assuming Caleb does not improve anything overnight.

CALEB
You mock me now.

MALACHI
We mocked you this morning.

CALEB
Consistency. That's brotherhood.

Small laugh.

JOSEPH
When real trouble comes, you'll know the difference.

CALEB
Oh?

JOSEPH
When trouble comes, we stand together.

The line should not become solemn. It is simply true to Joseph in this moment.

LEVI
That, we can agree on.

MALACHI
We can.

EZRA
Within reason.

CALEB
There he goes.

Caleb looks at Ezra and shakes his head. They laugh again.

MARY ARRIVES

The men move back into the work.

The rhythm begins again—easy now. Familiar.

Joseph has his back turned.

At the edge of the space, MARY appears.

SHIRA is with her.

The audience sees them.

The men do not.

Mary watches Joseph laughing with his friends.

Completely happy.

The unfinished table beside him.

The satchel she made him still on his shoulder.

Shira looks at Mary.

SHIRA
You want me to stay?

Mary looks at Joseph.

For a moment, she almost says yes.

MARY
No.

Beat.

MARY
Thank you.

Shira offers her hand. Mary takes it briefly.

SHIRA
Start with the truth.

Mary nods.

Shira moves away but does not need to disappear immediately. Mary is now alone at the edge of Joseph's world.

The men continue working.

CALEB
I'm just saying, eight chairs is a commitment.

JOSEPH
Are you still talking?

CALEB
I have questions.

EZRA
No one doubts that.

LEVI
Leave him alone.

CALEB
I am leaving him alone.

MALACHI
You are standing next to him.

CALEB
Emotionally.

Joseph laughs.

Then he turns.

He sees Mary.

His face immediately lights up.

JOSEPH
Mary!

That warmth should hurt.

Joseph crosses toward her.

JOSEPH
What are you doing here?

Then he sees her face.

His smile doesn't disappear immediately.

Concern replaces it.

JOSEPH
Hey.

Beat.

JOSEPH
What's wrong?

Mary tries.

MARY
Can we talk?

Behind Joseph, the work begins to stop.

Caleb starts toward them.

Malachi catches his arm.

CALEB
What?

Malachi gives him a look.

CALEB
Right.

Levi looks at Joseph.

Joseph gives him the smallest nod: I've got it.

LEVI
We'll finish tomorrow.

JOSEPH
All right.

The men begin putting down and gathering their tools.

Levi starts to leave, then turns back.

LEVI
Joseph.

Joseph looks at him.

LEVI
Tomorrow.

JOSEPH
Tomorrow.

Levi exits.

Ezra and Caleb follow.

Malachi lingers for only a moment.

MALACHI
We're here.

Joseph nods.

Malachi exits.

The rhythm that filled the room is gone.

Shira looks once more toward Mary.

Mary gives her a small nod.

I'm ready.

Shira exits.

TRANSITION INTO SCENE 6

Mary and Joseph are alone.

No blackout.

No ominous music.

The LED remains warm.

Nothing about Nazareth has changed.

The unfinished table remains.

The satchel Mary made is still on Joseph.

Everything Joseph believes his future will be is physically present around him.

He sets down the tool in his hand.

JOSEPH
Mary...

Beat.

JOSEPH
What happened?

Mary looks at him.

She remembers Shira's words.

Start with the truth.

MARY
I need to tell you something.

Scene 6 begins.